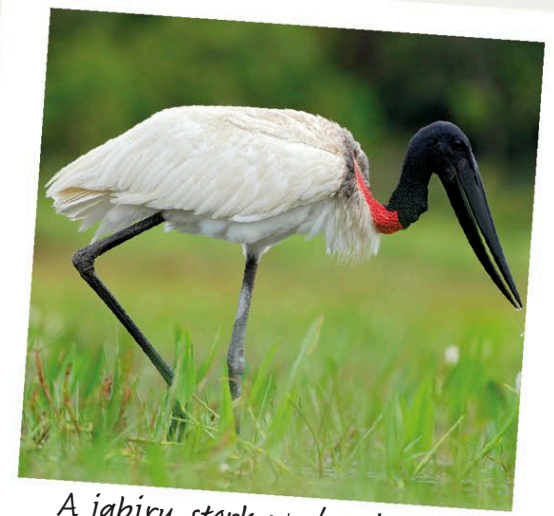


# Pantanal

The Pantanal is the world's largest wetland, which means a lot of it is underwater for much of the year. The 3,500 different plant species that grow here make it an ideal home for lots of birds and mammals, including the capybara, which is a giant relative of the guinea pig.

## Jabiru stork

The jabiru is the tallest flying bird in South and Central America, and can grow to over 3 ft (1 m) high. It grabs fish, frogs, and insects with its enormous bill.



*A jabiru stork wades through the Pantanal.*



This big freshwater snail grows up to 6 in (15 cm) long! It only comes out of the water at night to find food.

Channeled apple snail

About as big as a medium-sized dog, the capybara is the world's largest rodent.

Capybara

The roseate spoonbill sweeps its spoon-shaped bill from side to side to scoop up minnows—tiny freshwater fish.

Roseate spoonbill

Anacondas live in and out of water. They can be up to 29½ ft (9 m) long, but hide among water plants to surprise prey.



Green anaconda

The marsh deer has broad hooves that spread out to prevent them from sinking in marshy ground.



Marsh deer

This clever monkey uses rocks to crack nuts and crush crab shells to get at the food inside.



Hooded capuchin

This wetland plant's leaves can grow to 8 ft (2.5 m) across, and can hold an animal weighing up to 45 lb (20.5 kg)!

Giant water lily

## Location

The Pantanal lies south of the Amazon rain forest in Brazil, Bolivia, and Paraguay. It gets so much rain that 80 percent of it is flooded during the rainy season.



## PARAGUAY

## Giant otter

Found only in South American rivers and rain forests, giant otters get up to 4½ ft (1.4 m) long. They eat fish, crabs, and even small caimans!

## Yacare caiman

Caiman look like their alligator relatives, but have a pointier snout. The yacare gets up to 10 ft (3 m) long. Its favorite food is the piranha, but it also eats apple snails.

